Claire Barale

Pioneer Centre for AI, University of Copenhagen
Copenhagen, Denmark

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Personal Website | Google Scholar | Linkedin

Current position

2026 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Department of Computer Science, University of Copenhagen

Research experience

2025 – 2026 **Senior Research Engineer**
Bloomberg, London

2021 – 2026 **PhD Researcher**
School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh
Thesis: Learning to Understand Entities in Legal Texts
Supervisors: Michael Rovatsos, Nehal Bhuta
Examiners: Adam Lopez, Nikolaos Aletras, Simone Teufel
Affiliations: Artificial Intelligence Applications Institute (AIAI), Institute for Language, Cognition and Computation (ILCC), Centre for Technomoral Futures

2022 – 2025 **NLP Research Scientist** (part-time)
University of Edinburgh

2024 **Research Intern (PhD Fellowship)**
Bloomberg, New York

2023 **Consultant**
Weights & Biases, Edinburgh

2021 **Research Assistant**
PSL Research University – Paris Dauphine, LAMSADE lab
Supervisor: Alexis Tsoukiàs

Education

2026 **University of Edinburgh**
PhD, Informatics

2021 **PSL Research University – Paris Dauphine and École des Mines de Paris**
Master of Research, Computer Science

2017 **PSL Research University – Paris Dauphine**
BSc, Economics

Publications

Conference and Workshop Publications (Peer-Reviewed)

2026 Isabel Sebire, Claire Barale, Mirella Lapata, 'Faithfulness and Content Selection in Long-Input Multi-Document Summarisation of U.S. Civil Rights Litigation' (2026) *International Conference on AI and Law (ICAIL)*.

2025 Claire Barale, Leslie Barrett, Vikram Sunil Bajaj, Michael Rovatsos, 'LexTime: A Benchmark for Temporal Ordering of Legal Events' (2025) *Findings of EMNLP*.

2025 Aryo Pradipta Gema, Joshua Ong Jun Leang, Giwon Hong, Alessio Devoto, Alberto Carlo Maria Mancino, Rohit Saxena, Xuanli He, Yu Zhao, Xiaotang Du, Mohammad Reza Ghasemi Madani, Claire Barale, Robert McHardy, Joshua Harris, Jean Kaddour, Emile van Krieken, Pasquale Minervini, 'Are we done with MMLU?' (2025) *NAACL*.

2024 Drish Mali, Rubash Mali, Claire Barale, 'Information Extraction for Planning Court Cases' (2024) *Workshop on Natural Legal Language Processing (NLLP), EMNLP*.

2023 Claire Barale, Michael Rovatsos, Nehal Bhuta, 'Do Language Models Learn about Legal Entity Types during Pretraining?' (2023) *Workshop on Natural Legal Language Processing (NLLP), EMNLP*.

2023 Claire Barale, Mark Klaisoongnoen, Pasquale Minervini, Michael Rovatsos, Nehal Bhuta, 'AsyLex: A Dataset for Legal Language Processing of Refugee Claims' (2023) *Workshop on Natural Legal Language Processing (NLLP), EMNLP*.

2023 Claire Barale, Michael Rovatsos, Nehal Bhuta, 'Automated Refugee Case Analysis: An NLP Pipeline for Supporting Legal Practitioners' (2023) *Findings of ACL*.

2022 Claire Barale, 'Human-Centered Computing in Legal NLP: An Application to Refugee Status Determination' (2022) *Workshop on Bridging Human–Computer Interaction and Natural Language Processing (HCI+NLP), NAACL*.

Non-Archival Peer-Reviewed Presentations

2025 Mark Klaisoongnoen, Claire Barale, 'Numerical Reasoning in Legal and Financial Texts: A QA-Based Benchmark Using SEC Filings' (2025) *Bloomberg Symposium on Law and Language*.

2023 Claire Barale, 'fAsyLex: Accelerating Legal NLP through Comparative Analysis of Multi-GPU Approaches' (2023) *Women in High-Performance Computing Workshop (WHPC), SuperComputing (SC)*.

2023 Claire Barale, 'Empowering Refugee Claimants and their Lawyers: Using Machine Learning to Examine Decision-Making in Refugee Law' (2023) *Doctoral Consortium, International Conference on AI and Law (ICAIL)*.

Awarded Best Student Paper.

2022 Claire Barale, 'Refugee Status Determination: How Cooperation with Machine Learning Tools

Can Lead to More Justice' (2022) *SCOTLIN Early Career Scholars Symposium*.

2021 Alexis Tsoukiàs, Claire Barale, 'What is Fair Data Manipulation?' (2021) *European Conference on Operational Research*.

Talks

2026 'Semantic Understanding in Legal NLP'
Institute for Language, Cognition and Computation, University of Edinburgh

2025 'Temporal Reasoning with Large Language Models'
Centre for Technomoral Futures, Edinburgh Futures Institute

2025 'LexTime: A Benchmark for Temporal Event Ordering in Legal Texts'
Artificial Intelligence Applications Institute, University of Edinburgh

2025 'Temporal Reasoning on Legal Events'
ML and NLP Talk Series, Bloomberg;
Centre for Technomoral Futures, Edinburgh Futures Institute

2024 'Legal-Oriented Language Models for Legal Information Extraction'
ML and NLP Talk Series, Bloomberg

2023 'Information Extraction and Bias Analysis in Refugee Proceedings'
Artificial Intelligence Applications Institute, University of Edinburgh

2022–2023 'Enabling Ethical Human-AI Reasoning in International Law'
Artificial Intelligence Applications Institute, University of Edinburgh;
Centre for Technomoral Futures, Edinburgh Futures Institute

Awards

2023 – 2025 3-Year Bloomberg Data Science PhD Fellowship, total award of USD 233,505
2023 Best Student Paper Award, International Conference on AI and Law (ICAIL)
2021 – 2026 Cisco University Research Program Fund and the Baillie Gifford AI and Ethics PhD Program (PhD funding)

Travel Grants

2025 International Conference on AI and Law (ICAIL) student grant
2023 SIGHPC grant to attend SuperComputing (SC)
2022 HCI+NLP workshop grant to attend NAACL

Teaching and Supervision

MSc Research Projects, School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh

2024 Drish Mali: 'Information Extraction for Planning Court Cases'
2023 Isabel Sebire: 'Faithfulness and Content Selection in Long-Input Multi-Document Summarisation of U.S. Civil Rights Litigation'; awarded the Best MSc AI Dissertation Prize

Teaching, School of Informatics, University of Edinburgh

2025 Entrepreneurship and Innovation (MSc), Marker
2023 – 2024 Doing Research in Natural Language Processing (MSc), Marker
2023 Accelerated Natural Language Processing (MSc), Demonstrator
2022 Insights through Data (MSc), Teaching Assistant

Service and Outreach

Committees and Reviewing

Conferences: ACL Rolling Review (ARR), ACL, EMNLP, AIES, ICAIL
Workshops: Natural Legal Language Processing Workshop (NLLP)
Journals: Artificial Intelligence and Law

Workshop Organiser

2023 'NLP and Network Analysis in Financial Applications', ACM International Conference on AI in Finance (ICAIF), New York, 27 November 2023
Organisers: Leman Akoglu, Ivan Brugere, Mihai Cucuringu, Xiaowen Dong, Saurabh Nagrecha, Stefan Zohren, Lukasz Szpruch, Claire Barale, Mark Klaisoongnoen